

COMMUNICATIVE ENGLISH

Unit-II: Writing Skills

Comprehensive Study Notes for HPU BCA

1. Letter Writing

1.1 Introduction

Letter writing is an essential skill for effective communication, especially in professional and official contexts. It involves expressing ideas, requests, or information in a structured written format.

1.2 Types of Letters

Type	Description	Examples
Formal Letters	Official communication	Business letters, applications
Informal Letters	Personal communication	Letters to friends, family
Official/Business Correspondence	Professional communication	Letters to authorities, organizations

1.3 Structure of a Formal Letter

Component	Description	Example
Sender's Address	Writer's full address	123, Green Street, Delhi
Date	Date of writing	15th July 2026
Recipient's Address	Receiver's full address	The Manager, ABC Company
Subject Line	Brief statement of purpose	RE: Application for Leave
Salutation	Formal greeting	Dear Sir/Madam
Body	Main content (3 parts)	Introduction, details, conclusion

Closing	Formal ending	Yours faithfully/sincerely
Signature	Writer's name	Rahul Sharma

1.4 Job Application / Cover Letter

Purpose

To apply for a job position.

Structure

1. Reference to advertisement
2. Introduction of yourself
3. Your qualifications and experience
4. Interest in the position
5. Request for interview

Sample Letter

123, Green Valley Apartments
Shimla - 171001
15th July 2026

The Hiring Manager
ABC Technologies
456, Business Park
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: APPLICATION FOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

I am writing to apply for the position of Software Engineer at ABC Technologies, as advertised in The Times of India on 10th July 2026.

I am a BCA graduate from Himachal Pradesh University with a strong background in programming languages such as Java, Python, and C++. I have also completed an internship at XYZ Solutions, where I developed web applications and gained practical experience

in software development.

I am confident that my skills and enthusiasm make me a suitable candidate for this position. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application with you at an interview.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,

Signature

Rahul Sharma

Enclosure: CV

1.5 Letter of Complaint

Purpose

To register a complaint about a product or service.

Sample Letter

123, Green Valley Apartments
Shimla - 171001
15th July 2026

The Manager
Electronic World
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: COMPLAINT ABOUT DEFECTIVE PRODUCT

I am writing to bring to your attention that I purchased a laptop (Model XYZ, Serial Number 12345) from your store on 10th July 2026. The laptop has developed a screen flickering issue within 5 days of purchase.

I would appreciate it if you could replace the product or repair it at the earliest. I have attached the purchase receipt for your reference.

I look forward to your prompt response.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Rahul Sharma
Customer

1.6 Business Correspondence

A. Leave Application

123, Green Valley Apartments
Shimla - 171001
15th July 2026

The Principal
Himachal Pradesh University
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: APPLICATION FOR SICK LEAVE

I am writing to request sick leave for three days from 16th July to 18th July 2026 as I am suffering from high fever and have been advised bed rest by my doctor.

I have completed all pending assignments and will ensure that my absence does not cause any inconvenience. I will resume my duties on 19th July 2026.

Kindly grant me leave for the mentioned period.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Rahul Sharma
Roll No: 123
BCA Semester-II

B. Letter to Principal (Bonafide Certificate)

123, Green Valley Apartments
Shimla - 171001
15th July 2026

The Principal

Himachal Pradesh University
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: REQUEST FOR BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

I am writing to request a bonafide certificate as I need it for applying to a scholarship program. I am a student of BCA Semester-II with Roll No. 123 in your esteemed institution.

Kindly issue the certificate at the earliest.

Thanking you.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Rahul Sharma
Roll No: 123
BCA Semester-II

C. Order Letter

ABC Technologies
123, Business Park
Shimla - 171001
15th July 2026

The Sales Manager
XYZ Supplies
456, Industrial Area
Shimla - 171005

Dear Sir,

RE: ORDER FOR COMPUTER ACCESSORIES

We would like to place an order for the following items:

S.No.	Item	Quantity
-----	-----	-----
1	Computer Mouse	50 pieces

2	Keyboard	30 pieces
3	Monitor (22 inch)	10 pieces

Kindly deliver the items by 25th July 2026. Please send the invoice along with the delivery.

We look forward to a continued business relationship.

Yours faithfully,

Signature

Rahul Sharma
Purchase Manager

1.7 Key Phrases for Official Letters

Purpose	Useful Phrases
Requesting	I would be grateful if...
Apologizing	Please accept my sincere apologies...
Complaining	I am writing to complain about...
Ordering	We would like to place an order for...
Closing	I look forward to hearing from you...
Signing Off (Dear Sir/Madam)	Yours faithfully
Signing Off (Dear Mr/Ms)	Yours sincerely

2. Report Writing

2.1 What is a Technical Report?

A technical report is a document that presents information, findings, or recommendations on a specific technical topic. It is used in academic, scientific, and professional settings.

2.2 Types of Technical Reports

Type	Description
Research Report	Presents research findings
Project Report	Documents project progress and outcomes
Technical Report	Technical analysis and recommendations
Progress Report	Reports on ongoing work
Feasibility Report	Analyzes feasibility of a project
Incident Report	Reports on an incident or accident

2.3 Structure of a Technical Report

Section	Description
Title Page	Title, author, date, organization
Abstract/Summary	Brief overview of the report
Table of Contents	List of sections and sub-sections
Introduction	Background, purpose, scope

Body	Main content (methods, findings, analysis)
Conclusion	Summary and recommendations
References	List of sources cited
Appendices	Additional supporting material

2.4 Tips for Writing Technical Reports

1. Use clear, concise language
2. Organize information logically
3. Use headings and subheadings
4. Include relevant data and evidence
5. Use tables and figures appropriately
6. Proofread for accuracy and clarity

3. Notice Writing

3.1 What is a Notice?

A notice is a formal written announcement that provides information to a specific group of people. It is typically displayed on a notice board.

3.2 Structure of a Notice

Component	Description
Heading	"NOTICE" written at the top
Date	Date of issuing the notice
Title	Brief title indicating the purpose
Body	Main content (what, when, where, who)
Signature	Name and designation of the issuer

3.3 Sample Notice

NOTICE

Date: 15th July 2026

RE: ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATION

All students are hereby informed that the Annual Day Celebration of the college will be held on 25th July 2026 at 6:00 PM in the college auditorium.

Students interested in participating in cultural performances are requested to register their names with the Cultural Secretary by 20th July 2026.

All are cordially invited to attend.

Signature

Rahul Sharma
Cultural Secretary

4. Email Writing

4.1 Format of a Formal Email

Component	Description
To	Recipient's email address
Cc / Bcc	Carbon copy / Blind carbon copy
Subject	Clear and concise subject line
Salutation	Dear Sir/Madam / Dear Mr/Ms [Name]
Body	Introduction, main message, conclusion
Closing	Regards / Sincerely / Yours faithfully
Signature Block	Name, designation, contact details

4.2 Tips for Effective Emails

1. Use a clear and descriptive subject line
2. Keep the message concise and to the point
3. Use professional language and tone
4. Proofread before sending
5. Avoid using all caps or excessive punctuation
6. Include a proper signature with contact details
7. Reply promptly to emails
8. Use bullet points for clarity when needed

4.3 Sample Formal Email

To: hr@abctechnologies.com
Subject: Application for Software Engineer Position

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Software Engineer position at ABC Technologies. I came across the opening through your LinkedIn post.

I hold a BCA degree from Himachal Pradesh University and have practical experience in Java, Python, and web development. My resume is attached for your reference.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss my qualifications further in an interview.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Regards,
Rahul Sharma
BCA Graduate, HP University
Phone: 98765 43210
Email: rahul.sharma@email.com

To: professor@university.edu
Subject: Clarification regarding assignment deadline

Dear Professor,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to seek clarification regarding the deadline for the project assignment in the Communicative English course.

Could you please confirm whether the submission date is 25th July 2026 or if there has been any extension?

Thank you for your guidance.

Best regards,
Rahul Sharma
Roll No: 123
BCA Semester-II

5. CV Writing (Curriculum Vitae)

5.1 What is a CV?

A CV (Curriculum Vitae) is a comprehensive document that details a person's educational background, work experience, skills, and achievements. It is used for job applications and career advancement.

5.2 Structure of a CV

Section	Description
Personal Details	Name, Address, Contact Number, Email
Objective	Career goal statement
Education	Academic qualifications (reverse chronological)
Work Experience	Previous employment (reverse chronological)
Skills	Technical and soft skills
Achievements	Awards, recognitions
Extra-curricular Activities	Sports, arts, volunteering
References	Names and contact details of referees

5.3 Sample CV Format

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                        CURRICULUM VITAE
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PERSONAL DETAILS:

Name : Rahul Sharma
Date of Birth : 15th January 2004

Father's Name : Mr. Rajesh Sharma
Nationality : Indian
Marital Status : Unmarried
Languages Known : English, Hindi, Punjabi

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CONTACT DETAILS:

Address : 123, Green Valley Apartments, Shimla - 171001
Mobile : 98765 43210
Email : rahul.sharma@email.com

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OBJECTIVE:

To secure a challenging position in a reputable organization where I can utilize my technical skills and contribute to the growth of the company while enhancing my professional development.

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ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS:

Degree	Year	Institution	Percentage
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BCA	2026	HP University, Shimla	85%
12th (Science)	2023	HP Board	78%
10th	2021	HP Board	82%

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TECHNICAL SKILLS:

- Programming Languages: Java, Python, C++, SQL
 - Web Technologies: HTML, CSS, JavaScript
 - Database: MySQL, Oracle
 - MS Office Suite: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Access
- =====

WORK EXPERIENCE:

- Software Development Intern at XYZ Solutions (June-Aug 2025)
 - Developed web applications using Java and JavaScript
 - Worked on front-end and back-end development
- =====

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES:

- Member of College Computer Science Club
- Active participant in coding competitions

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REFERENCES:

1. Dr. Suresh Kumar
Professor, Department of Computer Science
Himachal Pradesh University, Shimla
Mobile: 98765 43211

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6. Precis Writing, Comprehension & Paragraph Writing

6.1 Precis Writing

Rules for Precis Writing

Rule	Description
1. Read Carefully	Understand the passage fully
2. Identify Main Ideas	Find the key points
3. Write in Your Own Words	Avoid copying directly
4. Keep it Concise	Use as few words as possible
5. Maintain Logical Flow	Ideas should flow logically
6. Use One Paragraph	Typically one paragraph
7. Avoid Examples	Exclude examples and illustrations
8. Write in Past Tense	Usually in past tense

Steps for Writing a Precis

1. Read the passage carefully
2. Underline key points and main ideas
3. Remove unnecessary details (examples, illustrations, repetitions)
4. Write the precis in your own words
5. Check the length (usually one-third of the original)
6. Revise and edit for clarity and conciseness

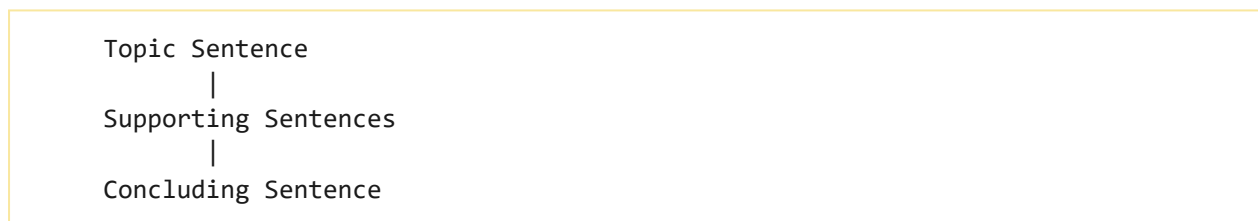
6.2 Comprehension

How to Attempt Comprehension Questions

Step	Action
1	Read the passage quickly to get the general idea
2	Read the questions carefully
3	Read the passage again, focusing on relevant parts
4	Answer in your own words
5	Use complete sentences
6	Check your answers for accuracy

6.3 Paragraph Writing

Structure of a Paragraph



Characteristics of a Good Paragraph

1. **Unity:** All sentences support the main idea
2. **Coherence:** Sentences flow logically
3. **Development:** Main idea is adequately explained
4. **Cohesion:** Sentences are connected using transitions

Types of Paragraphs

Type	Description	Example Topic
Descriptive	Describes a person, place, or thing	My Best Friend
Narrative	Tells a story	My First Day at School

Expository	Explains or informs	The Importance of Education
Persuasive	Convinces the reader	Why We Should Recycle

7. Writing Agenda and Circulars

7.1 Writing Agenda

What is an Agenda?

An agenda is a list of items to be discussed or acted upon during a meeting. It helps the meeting stay focused and organized.

Structure of an Agenda

Component	Description
Header	Name of organization, meeting type, date, time, venue
List of Items	Numbered or bulleted list of topics
Time Allocation	Suggested time for each item

Sample Agenda

XYZ COLLEGE
ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
AGENDA

Date: 25th July 2026
Time: 10:00 AM
Venue: Conference Hall

AGENDA

1. Reading and approval of previous minutes
2. Progress report on various activities
3. Discussion on budget allocation
4. Planning for upcoming events
5. Any other matter with permission
6. Vote of thanks

7.2 Writing Circulars

What is a Circular?

A circular is a document that is distributed to a large number of people to inform them about a policy, rule, or event.

Structure of a Circular

Component	Description
Header	"CIRCULAR" at the top
Reference Number	Unique identification number
Date	Date of issue
Subject	Brief statement of purpose
Body	Main content (what, why, how)
Signature	Name and designation of the issuer

Sample Circular

CIRCULAR

Ref: XYZ/2026/01

Date: 15th July 2026

RE: CHANGE IN LIBRARY TIMINGS

All students are hereby informed that the library timings have been changed with immediate effect. The new timings are:

Monday to Friday: 9:00 AM to 8:00 PM

Saturday: 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM

Sunday: Closed

Students are requested to return borrowed books by the due date to avoid penalties.

Signature

Rahul Sharma

Librarian

8. Questions Section

8.1 Short Answer Questions (2-5 Marks)

1. What are the different types of letters?
2. What is the structure of a formal letter?
3. What is a CV? What are its components?
4. What is a precis? What are its rules?
5. What is comprehension?
6. What is the structure of a paragraph?
7. What is a notice? How is it written?
8. What is an agenda? Why is it important?
9. What is a circular? How is it different from a notice?
10. What is the difference between a CV and a resume?

8.2 Long Answer Questions (10 Marks)

1. Explain the structure and components of a formal letter with an example.
2. Write a job application letter for the post of Software Engineer.
3. What is a CV? Prepare a CV for a fresh graduate applying for a job.
4. What is a technical report? Explain its types and structure.
5. Explain the rules and steps for writing a precis with an example.
6. Write a paragraph on "The Importance of Education" (200 words).

8.3 Practice Questions

1. Write a letter to the Principal requesting a bonafide certificate.
2. Write a letter of complaint about a defective product.
3. Write a CV for a BCA student applying for an internship.
4. Write a notice for an upcoming college event.
5. Write an agenda for a college meeting.

8.4 Quick Revision: Letter Writing Structure

Sender's Address
Date
Recipient's Address
Subject: RE: [Purpose]
Salutation (Dear Sir/Madam)

[Introduction]
[Main Content]
[Conclusion]

Yours faithfully/sincerely,

Signature
Name
Designation

8.5 Quick Revision: Precis Rules

1. Read carefully
2. Identify main ideas
3. Write in your own words
4. Keep it concise
5. Maintain logical flow
6. Use one paragraph
7. Avoid examples
8. Write in past tense

8.6 Quick Revision: Paragraph Structure

Topic Sentence
|
Supporting Sentences
|
Concluding Sentence

End of Unit-II Notes